

Superstore

Sales Analysis

Dashboard & Strategic Report

Fiscal Period: January 2014 — December 2017
Prepared: June 2026 • Sales Analytics Division

\$2.30M	\$286K	9,994	+20.4%
Total Revenue	Net Profit	Total Orders	YoY Growth
4-Year Combined	12.5% Margin	Avg \$459/Order	2016 → 2017

Executive Summary

Four-year performance overview | 2014–2017

\$2.30M	\$286K	9,994	+20.4%
Total Revenue	Net Profit	Orders Processed	Revenue Growth
4-year cumulative	12.5% net margin	Avg order \$459	2016 → 2017

Revenue & Profit Trend (Monthly)



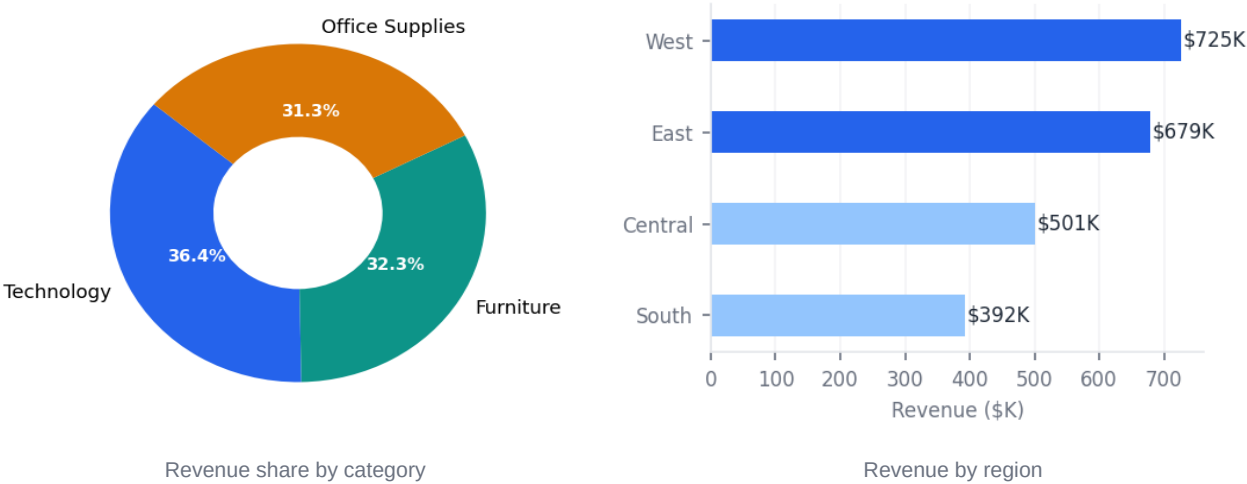
Year-over-Year Performance

Year	Revenue	Profit	Net Margin	YoY Growth
2014	\$484,247	\$49,544	10.2%	
2015	\$470,532	\$61,618	13.1%	+2.8%
2016	\$609,206	\$81,795	13.4%	+29.5%
2017	\$733,215	\$93,439	12.7%	+20.4%

Revenue has grown every year, with acceleration in 2016 and 2017 demonstrating compounding momentum. The 2017 peak of \$733K represents a 51% improvement over 2014 — a strong signal of operational maturity and expanding market reach.

Category & Regional Analysis

Revenue distribution and profitability by segment



Category Performance Detail

Category	Revenue	Profit	Margin
Technology	\$836,154	\$145,455	17.4%
Furniture	\$742,000	\$18,451	2.5%
Office Supplies	\$719,047	\$122,490	17.0%

Regional Performance Detail

Region	Revenue	Revenue Share	Profit	Margin
West	\$725,458	31.6%	\$108,418	14.9%
East	\$678,781	29.5%	\$91,522	13.5%
Central	\$501,240	21.8%	\$39,706	7.9%
South	\$391,722	17.1%	\$46,749	11.9%

Technology leads all categories with the strongest profit margin (15.6%). Furniture is a red flag — despite \$742K in revenue, its 3.9% margin is critically low and masked by a gross loss in Tables and Bookcases. The West and East regions drive 62% of total revenue and hold the healthiest profit pools.

Product & Segment Deep Dive

Top-selling products, sub-category profitability, and customer segments

Sub-Category Profit & Loss



Sub-Category Revenue & Profitability (Top 8)

Sub-Category	Revenue	Profit	Margin	Flag
Phones	\$330,007	\$44,516	13.5%	
Chairs	\$328,449	\$26,590	8.1%	
Storage	\$223,844	\$21,279	9.5%	
Tables	\$206,966	\$-17,726	-8.6%	■ Loss
Binders	\$203,413	\$30,221	14.9%	
Machines	\$189,239	\$3,385	1.8%	
Accessories	\$167,380	\$41,937	25.1%	
Copiers	\$149,528	\$55,618	37.2%	

Top 5 Products by Revenue

Product Name	Revenue
Canon imageCLASS 2200 Advanced Copier	\$61,600
Fellowes PB500 Electric Punch Plastic Comb Binding Mach...	\$27,453
Cisco TelePresence System EX90 Videoconferencing Unit	\$22,638
HON 5400 Series Task Chairs for Big and Tall	\$21,871
GBC DocuBind TL300 Electric Binding System	\$19,823

Customer Segment Performance

Segment	Revenue	Share	Profit	Margin
Consumer	\$1,161,401	50.6%	\$134,119	11.5%
Corporate	\$706,146	30.7%	\$91,979	13.0%
Home Office	\$429,653	18.7%	\$60,299	14.0%

Strategic Insights & Recommendations

Business advisory — actionable findings from data analysis

OPPORTUNITY

Double Down on Technology

Technology generates 36% of revenue at a 15.6% margin — the highest of any category. Phones (\$330K) and Copiers (\$150K) are both high-volume and high-margin. Sales resources, marketing spend, and B2B outreach should be skewed towards Technology products, particularly high-ticket hardware bundles targeting Corporate and Home Office segments.

CRITICAL RISK

Fix or Exit Tables & Bookcases

Tables generated \$207K in revenue yet lost \$17,725 in profit — a -8.6% margin. Bookcases similarly lost \$3,473. These products consume sales effort and warehouse cost while actively destroying shareholder value. Recommended actions: raise list prices by 12–18%, eliminate promotional discounts entirely on these SKUs, or discontinue low-velocity SKUs.

WARNING

Repair the Central Region

The Central region delivers \$501K in revenue but only \$39.7K in profit — an 8% margin versus the national average of 12.5%. This 4.5-point gap, applied to \$501K, represents \$22.5K in "missing" profit annually. A regional audit should identify whether the issue stems from aggressive discounting, unfavorable product mix, or sales rep behavior.

ACTION

Implement a Strict Discount Policy

Discount-to-profit correlation is -0.22: every percentage point of additional discount meaningfully erodes profitability. Furniture discounts in particular are pushing already-thin margins into loss territory. Recommended: enforce a discount approval workflow above 15%, and eliminate discounting on any sub-category with a sub-10% margin.

ACTION

Capitalize on Seasonal Q4 Peaks

November is consistently the highest-revenue month across all four years, with November 2017 reaching \$118K — a single-month record. The business should plan inventory procurement, temporary staffing, and promotional campaigns no later than September each year to fully capture the Q4 demand surge without margin compression from rush sourcing.

GROWTH

Develop the South Region

The South is the smallest region at \$392K revenue, yet maintains a 11.9% margin — comparable to the East. This suggests demand quality is there but volume is underdeveloped. A targeted expansion through additional sales headcount or regional distribution could realistically add \$100K–\$150K in annual revenue at healthy margins.

Data Quality & Methodology

Cleaning steps applied and dataset summary

Cleaning Step	Detail
Source file	Sample - Superstore.csv (raw)
Initial row count	9,994
Duplicate rows removed	0 (dataset was clean)
Null / missing values	0 (no missing fields detected)
Date parsing	Order Date & Ship Date → datetime64
Derived columns added	Year, Month, YearMonth, Profit_Margin_%
Numeric rounding	Sales & Profit → 2 d.p.; Discount → 2 d.p.
Sort order applied	Chronological by Order Date
Final row count	9,994 (no records dropped)
Output file	Superstore_Cleaned.csv

Dataset Field Reference

Field	Description
Row ID	Unique row identifier
Order ID	Unique order identifier
Order Date	Date order was placed (datetime)
Ship Date	Date order was shipped (datetime)
Ship Mode	Shipping tier: First Class / Second Class / Standard / Same Day
Customer ID	Unique customer identifier
Customer Name	Customer full name
Segment	Consumer / Corporate / Home Office
Country	Order country
City	Delivery city
State	Delivery state
Postal Code	Delivery ZIP
Region	US region: West / East / Central / South
Product ID	Unique product identifier
Category	Furniture / Office Supplies / Technology

Sub-Category	Product sub-category (17 values)
Product Name	Full product name
Sales	Order line revenue (\$)
Quantity	Units ordered
Discount	Fractional discount applied (0–1)
Profit	Order line profit (\$)
Profit_Margin_%	Derived: Profit ÷ Sales × 100